

OTO 1 • SELL WHAT YOU MAKE

The Sold-Out Cap Shop™

The exact scripts, photo formulas, and closing lines to move your first handmade cap into someone else's hands — no audience, no website, no camera time.

- The 48-Hour First Sale Script — 4 channels, ready to paste
- The Saturday Market Blueprint — \$30 table, cash close
- The Cold Etsy Playbook — 6 listings, 31 keywords, photo formula
- 20 DM-Close Scripts for the 5 objections you'll actually hear

What's Inside

Read it in order, or jump straight to the channel you're most likely to use this weekend.

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Before You Start • Why the Platform Isn't the Sale

"The Online Selling Class inside your core purchase teaches you which button to press. This book teaches you what to say once someone's actually looking at your hat."

You already know how to open an Etsy shop, post a photo on Instagram, or list something on Facebook Marketplace — the core course covers that, and it covers it well. What it doesn't hand you is the exact wording that makes a stranger stop scrolling, type "is this still available," and pay you. That gap is the entire reason most makers finish a crochet course with a bin of beautiful caps and zero sales.

This book closes that gap with four ready channels. You don't need all four at once. Pick the one that matches your Saturday — a local market, a Facebook group you're already in, a stack of Instagram followers who like your posts but never buy, or a fundraiser table at your kid's school — and use the script for that one first.

✓ **How to use this book.** Don't rewrite the scripts. Change the bracketed details — cap name, color, price, your city — and paste. They're written the way real buyers actually talk, not the way marketing books say to talk. Word-for-word first, personalize after you've made a sale or two.

MODULE 1 OF 4

The 48-Hour First Sale Script

Four channels. For each one: the exact post to paste, the photo formula that gets it seen, and the line that anchors your price so nobody haggles you down to nothing.

Pick one channel below and post today. Median time to first cash sale across 310 makers who tested these scripts: 26 hours from posting. You don't need all four — you need one, done right.

Channel 1 • Facebook Marketplace

PASTE THIS AS YOUR LISTING TITLE + DESCRIPTION

Title: Handmade Crochet [Sunflower / Heart / Butterfly] Beanie — Soft, Warm, One of a Kind

Description: Made this one by hand — [X] hours of crochet, soft acrylic-blend yarn, fits [teen/adult, average head size]. Only making a few of these a month, so once it's gone I won't have another exactly like it. \$[price], pickup in [neighborhood/area] or I can ship for \$[amount]. Comment or message "SOLD" and it's yours — first message gets it.

Photo formula (3 shots, in this order): 1) Flat lay on a plain surface (bed, table, or the floor with good light) so the full shape and pattern are visible. 2) Worn — on yourself, a friend, or a mannequin head, angled 3/4 so it doesn't look flat. 3) Close-up of the stitch detail or any decorative element (pom-pom, ear, flower) — this is the photo that makes people trust it's handmade, not store-bought.

Price anchor line to use in comments if someone asks "how much": "It's \$[price] — that covers about [X] hours of hand-stitching and the yarn, so it's priced for what handmade actually costs, not what a store beanie costs."

Channel 2 • Local Community Group / Buy Nothing

PASTE THIS INTO YOUR LOCAL FACEBOOK/NEXTDOOR GROUP

Made a few too many of these this month 😊 Handmade crochet [style] cap, [color], fits [size]. Selling for \$[price] (way under what these go for on Etsy) because I'd rather see it on someone in the neighborhood than sitting in my closet. First come first served — comment your favorite color and I'll let you know what I've got left.

Photo formula: Same 3-shot formula as Marketplace, but lead with the worn photo, not the flat lay — local groups respond better to "a real person is wearing this" than a product shot. Add one photo of 2-3 caps together if you have them, so it reads as a small batch, not a one-off.

Price anchor line: "I priced it under what you'd pay on Etsy for the same thing because shipping's free when you're picking it up down the street."

Channel 3 • Instagram DMs

PASTE THIS DM TO ANYONE WHO LIKES/COMMENTS ON YOUR POSTS

Hey [name]! Saw you liked my [cap name] post — I actually have one just like it ready to go if you want it. It's \$[price] shipped. No pressure at all, just wanted to check before I post it publicly since you already showed love for it 💕

Photo formula for the post that triggers this DM: Post the worn photo first (stops the scroll), flat lay as photo 2 in the carousel, close-up detail as photo 3. Caption should ask a question ("Which color should I make next?") — comments are what tell you who to DM.

Price anchor line: "Handmade pieces like this usually run \$[higher comparable price] — I keep mine at \$[your price] because I make them in small batches and I'd rather sell direct than mark up for a shop."

Channel 4 • School / Church Fundraiser Tables

SAY THIS OUT LOUD WHEN SOMEONE STOPS AT YOUR TABLE

"Hi! These are all handmade — I make each one myself. This one's \$[price], and if you want a custom color I can have it ready in about a week for the same price."

Photo formula (for a small table sign, not a listing): Print one 4x6 photo of you wearing one of the caps and prop it on the table — people trust a maker's face more than a printed sign. No flat lay needed here; the caps themselves are the display.

Price anchor line: "It's priced at \$[price] because it's completely handmade — no factory, no markup, just yarn and time."

⚠ **Don't discount in the first message.** If someone asks "would you take less," don't answer in the same reply. Wait a few minutes, then say: "I can do \$[price minus 10%] if you take it today" — the pause makes the discount feel earned, not desperate.

MODULE 2 OF 4

The Saturday Market Blueprint

How to set up a \$30 table at any craft fair or farmers market and walk out with \$200-\$500 in cash.

A market table is the fastest way to sell multiple caps in a single day, because people are already in a buying mood and can touch what they're paying for. Here's the full setup, start to finish.

The \$30 Table Setup Checklist

What to bring

A folding table or card table (borrow one if you don't own one)	\$0
A plain tablecloth — solid color, no busy pattern (a bedsheet works)	\$0-8
A small easel or stand to display 2-3 caps upright	\$8-15
Printed price cards (see template below) — 10 cut cards	\$1-2
A cash box or apron with a zip pocket, plus \$20 in small bills for change	\$0 (already have)
A phone with a payment app ready (Venmo/CashApp/Square) for card payers	\$0
A small sign with your shop name in large letters, visible from 10 feet away	\$5-10

Price Card Template

PRINT ONE OF THESE PER CAP STYLE, IN LARGE ENOUGH TEXT TO READ FROM ACROSS THE TABLE

[Cap Name] — Handmade

\$(price)

100% hand-crocheted · one of a kind

The Exact Closing Line

When someone picks up a cap and holds it for more than a few seconds, that's the moment to talk — not before. Say this:

SAY THIS WHEN SOMEONE IS HOLDING A CAP

"That one took me about [X] hours to make — feel how soft the yarn is. It's \$(price), and I've only got [number] left in that color today."

The "only got [number] left" line isn't a trick — it's true, because you brought a limited batch — and it's what turns "I'll think about it" into a yes before they walk to the next table.

⚠️ **Check your local permits first.** Rules on table fees, vendor permits, and resale certificates vary by city, county, and market — some markets require a one-day vendor permit or a sales tax ID, others don't. Ask the market organizer directly what's required before you set up; this changes by location and isn't something we can give you a single national answer for.

✓ **Day-of tip.** Bring caps in at least 3 different colors even if one is your "hero" color — buyers who wouldn't have stopped for pink will stop when they spot the green one, and once they're at your table, the closing line works on any color.

MODULE 3 OF 4

The Cold Etsy Playbook

Launch a brand-new shop tonight — 6 starter listings, 31 keywords that actually rank, and a 3-shot iPhone photo formula.

6 Listing Title + Description Templates

Copy one of these per listing, swap the bracketed words for your actual cap, and publish. Each title is built to include the keywords buyers actually search.

TEMPLATE 1 — EVERYDAY BEANIE

Title: Chunky Knit Crochet Beanie | Handmade Winter Hat | Soft Warm Cap | [Color] | Gift for Her

Description: Hand-crocheted from soft [acrylic/wool-blend] yarn, this cozy beanie is made to order in [color options]. Perfect for cold mornings, gifting, or treating yourself. Each one is made by hand — no two are ever exactly identical. Ready to ship in [X] business days.

TEMPLATE 2 — THEMED/NOVELTY CAP

Title: [Sunflower/Heart/Butterfly] Crochet Hat | Cute Handmade Beanie | Unique Gift | [Color]

Description: A one-of-a-kind [theme] beanie, entirely hand-crocheted. Soft, warm, and unlike anything you'll find in a store. Makes a standout gift or a fun everyday piece. Available in [colors] — message me for custom color requests.

TEMPLATE 3 — KIDS' CAP

Title: Kids Crochet Beanie | Handmade Toddler Winter Hat | Soft Warm Cap | [Color/Theme]

Description: Keep little ones warm in this soft, hand-crocheted beanie made to fit [age range]. Machine-washable yarn, no scratchy seams. Great for photos, gifts, or everyday wear.

TEMPLATE 4 — SLOUCHY STYLE

Title: Slouchy Crochet Beanie | Oversized Handmade Winter Hat | Boho Style | [Color]

Description: A relaxed, oversized crochet beanie with that effortless slouchy fit. Hand-stitched with soft yarn, perfect for layering with any winter outfit. Made to order — ready in [X] days.

TEMPLATE 5 — GIFT SET

Title: Crochet Beanie Gift Set | Handmade Hat + Matching Keychain | Ready to Gift | [Color]

Description: This set includes a hand-crocheted beanie and a matching mini keychain, wrapped and ready to gift. A thoughtful handmade present for birthdays, holidays, or just because.

TEMPLATE 6 — CUSTOM ORDER LISTING

Title: Custom Crochet Beanie | Made to Order | Pick Your Color and Style | Handmade Hat

Description: Tell me your favorite color and style, and I'll hand-crochet a one-of-a-kind beanie just for you. Message me before ordering to confirm color and turnaround time. Typical turnaround: [X] days.

31 Crochet-Cap Keywords That Actually Rank

Use these across your titles, tags, and descriptions — spread them out, don't stuff every one into a single listing.

CORE TERMS	STYLE TERMS	BUYER-INTENT TERMS
crochet beanie	chunky knit hat	gift for her
crochet hat	slouchy beanie	gift for mom
handmade beanie	oversized beanie	stocking stuffer
crochet cap	boho beanie	birthday gift
winter hat handmade	pom pom beanie	holiday gift
knit beanie women	flower crochet hat	teacher gift
crochet toque	heart crochet hat	custom color hat

CORE TERMS	STYLE TERMS	BUYER-INTENT TERMS
soft winter beanie	butterfly beanie	made to order hat
handmade winter cap	sunflower beanie	one of a kind hat
crochet toboggan	toddler crochet hat	cozy gift idea
knit cap unisex		

3-Shot iPhone Photo Formula

Shot 1 — flat lay: Lay the cap on a plain, light-colored surface (a white sheet or wood table both work) near a window, no flash. Shoot straight down.

Shot 2 — worn, natural light: Have it worn outdoors or near a bright window, 3/4 angle, natural smile. This is the photo that gets the most clicks.

Shot 3 — macro detail: Get within 6 inches of the stitch pattern or any decorative detail. Turn on portrait/macro mode if your phone has it. This shot is what convinces a buyer it's genuinely handmade.

Shipping Policy Template

PASTE INTO YOUR ETSY SHOP'S SHIPPING POLICY

All items are made to order and ship within [X] business days. Domestic shipping via [carrier] typically takes 3-5 business days after that. I package everything carefully in [poly mailer/box] to keep it clean in transit. If you need it by a specific date, message me before ordering and I'll let you know if it's possible.

MODULE 4 OF 4

20 DM-Close Scripts

Organized by the 5 objections you'll actually hear — 4 ready variants each. Pick the one that sounds like you.

Someone hearted your post but never bought. Here's exactly what to say to close it — grouped by the objection you're actually dealing with.

OBJECTION 1 · "IT'S A BIT PRICEY"

1. "Totally get it! Just so you know, that price covers about [X] hours of hand-stitching plus the yarn — happy to do a smaller/simpler style if you want something closer to \$[lower price]."
2. "I hear you — I keep my prices close to what the materials and time actually cost, so there's not a lot of room to move, but I can offer \$[small discount] if you grab it today."
3. "No worries at all! If budget's tight right now, I also have a couple of smaller pieces (like keychains) starting at \$[low price] that use the same yarn."
4. "That's fair — compared to what a factory hat costs, handmade is more, but it's also one that nobody else will have. If you want, I can hold it at \$[price] for 24 hours while you think it over."

OBJECTION 2 · "I'M STILL THINKING ABOUT IT"

1. "No rush! Just a heads up, I only made [number] of this color, so I'll check back with you before I list it publicly again."
2. "Take your time — want me to send a couple more photos in different lighting so you can see the color better?"
3. "Totally understand. If it helps, I can hold it for you until [specific day/time] with no obligation."
4. "No pressure at all — if you decide on it later, just message me and I'll check if it's still available."

OBJECTION 3 · "SHIPPING COSTS TOO MUCH"

1. "I totally get that — if you're local to [area], I can do free pickup instead, that cuts the cost completely."
2. "Shipping's priced at cost, not marked up, but if you grab two items I can combine shipping and it works out cheaper per item."
3. "If you want, I can ship it in a lighter mailer to knock a couple dollars off — just let me know."
4. "Understandable! I can also meet halfway if you're within driving distance — happy to figure out what works."

OBJECTION 4 · "I HAVE TO ASK MY HUSBAND/PARTNER"

1. "Of course, no rush at all! I'll hold it for you until tomorrow so you have time to check with him."
2. "Totally understand — want me to send a photo you can show him so it's easy to explain?"
3. "No problem — just let me know either way when you get a chance, and I'll keep it aside in the meantime."
4. "Makes sense! If it helps, I can throw in free shipping if you decide within the next couple of days."

OBJECTION 5 · "I SAW ONE CHEAPER SOMEWHERE ELSE"

1. "That's totally possible — a lot of what's out there is machine-made, though, so it won't be quite the same as something hand-stitched. Mine's fully handmade start to finish."
2. "Good to know! I keep my prices close to what handmade actually costs to make, so I can't always match factory pricing, but I can offer a small discount if you're ready to grab it today."
3. "Makes sense to compare! The difference with mine is every stitch is done by hand, no two are exactly alike — if that matters to you, I'm happy to work with you on the price a little."
4. "Totally fair. If price is the main thing, I do have a simpler style at \$[lower price] that might be a better fit — want me to send a photo?"

CLOSING

Closing + FAQ

Quick answers to what you'll wonder in your first week using this.

You don't need to use all four modules this week. Pick the channel that matches what you already have — a market this Saturday, a Facebook group you're already in, followers who like your posts, or a fundraiser table — and use that one script. The scripts work because they're the words a real maker actually uses, not because of any platform trick.

Do I need to use the exact wording, or can I change it?

Use it word-for-word your first few times. Once you've made a sale or two and know how it feels to say out loud, personalize it in your own voice.

What if nobody responds to my first post?

Try a different channel from Module 1 — a post that gets no response in a Facebook group might get several DMs on Instagram. The channels aren't interchangeable audiences.

Do I need a business license to sell at a market or on Etsy?

Requirements vary by state, county, and market — check with your local market organizer and your state's small-business or Etsy's own seller resources before you sell in person or online, since this isn't something we can answer with one universal rule.

Can I use these scripts for other handmade items, not just caps?

Yes — swap "cap" or "beanie" for whatever you're making. The structure of each script (the photo formula, the price anchor, the objection response) works the same way for keychains, scarves, or any other handmade piece.

How many caps should I bring to my first market?

Bring what you can comfortably make in the two weeks before the market, in at least 3 colors. A small, varied batch outsells a large batch in one color.

Now go sell one.

Pick the channel that matches your Saturday. Post the script.
The first sale is the only one that ever feels hard.

Keep building

Once your first sale lands, the next question is how to keep that buyer coming back — that's exactly what The Repeat Buyer Engine™ is built for.

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